MEC TRACKER

User Guide

Turn Premiere's native mask tracking into Transform keyframes, in a few clicks. For Premiere Pro 2026.

1. Install

Windows

- Unzip the download.
- Double-click `Install-Windows.bat` and accept the administrator prompt.
- Restart Premiere Pro.

Mac

- Unzip the download.
- Open Terminal, type `bash` and drag `Install-Mac.command` into the window, then press Enter.
- Restart Premiere Pro.

Open the plugin in Premiere: **Window > UXP Plugins > Mec Tracker**. Manual install (Windows): copy the folder `com.mectracker` to `C:\Program Files\Common Files\Adobe\UXP\Plugins\External\`.

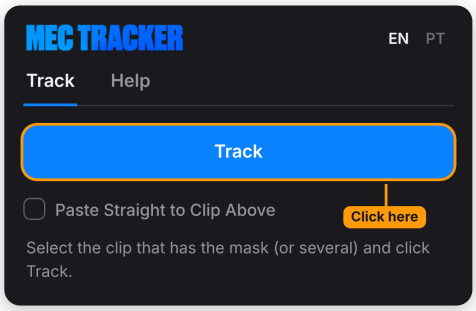
2. How to use

1 Prepare the mask

On the clip that has the object, create a mask (rectangle, pen or Object Mask) and use Premiere's own tracking (*Track selected mask forward*) until the end of the clip. The mask can stay inside Opacity or in *Unassigned Masks* (an Object Mask must be inside Opacity).

2 Track

Select the clip on the timeline and press **Track** (orange box). Wait for the progress bar to finish. The **Paste** button only shows up after tracking: the blue button is always the next step.



3 Pick the target

Select the text, image or graphic that should follow the object (it can be more than one). Park the timeline playhead on the frame where it is already placed correctly.

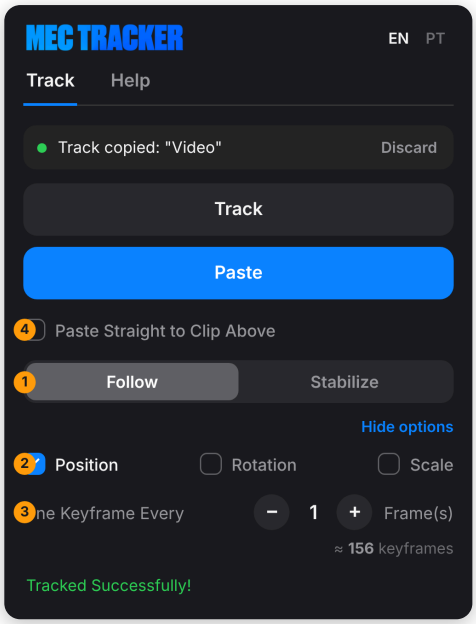
4 Adjust

1 **Follow**: the target follows the object. **Stabilize**: the target does the opposite, to hold the object still.

2 Tick what to copy: **Position**, **Rotation** and/or **Scale**.

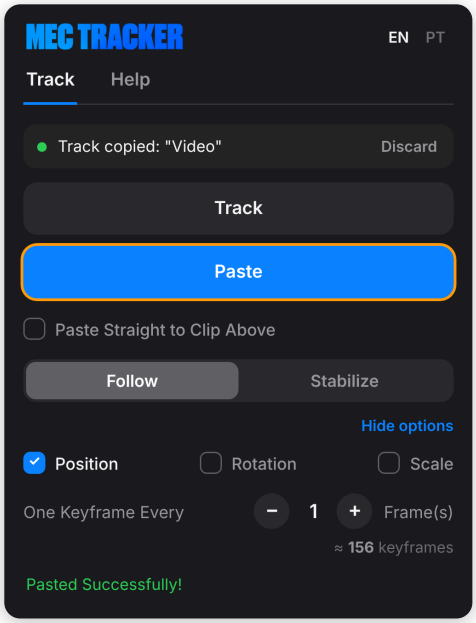
3 **One Keyframe Every**: use – and +. 1 is the most accurate; higher numbers give smoother motion with fewer keyframes.

4 **Paste Straight to Clip Above**: see sections 3 and 4.



5 Paste

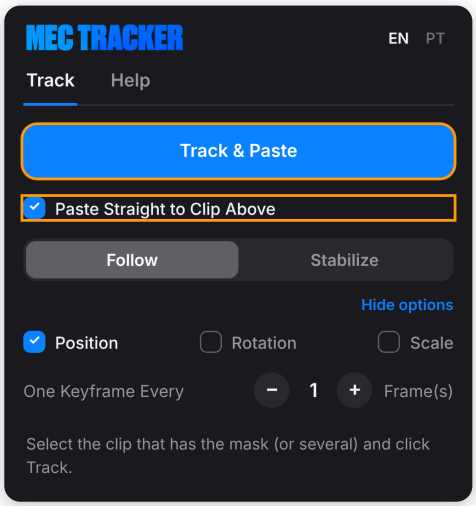
Press **Paste** (orange box), which is now the blue button. Mec Tracker creates the **Transform** effect (Uniform Scale on, Shutter Angle 360) with the keyframes for you. On graphics clips it is placed right above the Text component. You can select several targets and paste on all of them at once. To track another clip, use the grey **Track** button on top.



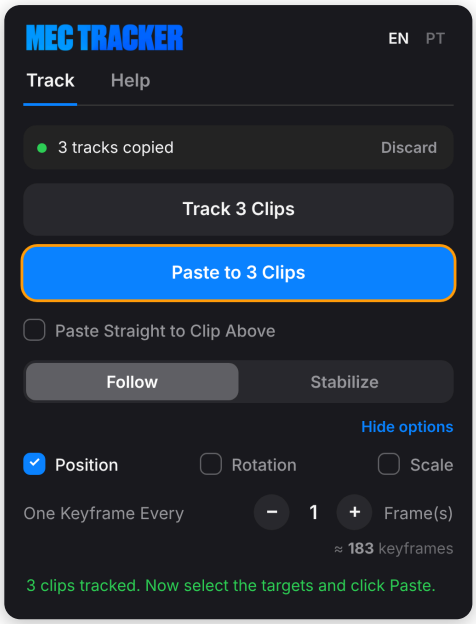
3. Paste Straight to Clip Above

Tick **Paste Straight to Clip Above** and the button becomes **Track & Paste**. With one click, Mec Tracker tracks the masked clip and immediately pastes the keyframes onto the clip on the nearest track above it (for example, the text over the video), using the options you chose.

If there are several clips above at that time, it pastes on all of them. If there is nothing above, it tells you and keeps the track: untick the box and the **Paste** button shows up so you can paste manually. Where the target ends up is anchored to the playhead (when it is inside the tracked clip) or to the start of the clip.



4. Several clips at once



Select several masked clips on the timeline. What happens depends on the **Paste Straight to Clip Above** box:

A **Off**: **Track** tracks all of them, one at a time, and keeps the tracks. Then select the targets and press **Paste**. Each target gets the track of the clip it overlaps most in time; a target that overlaps none is skipped.

B **On**: **Track & Paste** tracks each clip and pastes onto the clip on the track right above it.

The buttons show how many clips are selected (for example, **Track 3 Clips** or **Paste to 3 Clips**), so you can confirm before clicking.

The bar shows which clip it is on, and **Cancel** stops everything (what was already done stays).

- With the box on, you can select the texts/Nests too: they are used as targets, not tracked.
- A clip with no mask or nothing above it is skipped; the Log says why.
- A text that crosses a cut goes only to the clip it covers the most.
- In **Track & Paste**, each clip uses its first frame as the reference. In **Paste**, the playhead counts when it is inside the shared stretch; otherwise, the start of that stretch.

5. The Help tab

The same quick steps are inside the plugin, in the **Help** tab. It also has the **Log**: if something goes wrong, open the Log, click **Copy** and send it to the creator.

6. Tips and troubleshooting

- After tracking, the green strip above the buttons shows the copied track; **Discard** clears it.
- **Hide options** folds Position, Rotation, Scale and the interval, leaving just a summary; **Show options** opens them again.
- If the mask is in *Unassigned Masks*, save the project (Ctrl+S) before tracking. The plugin reads the mask from the project file. This does not work for **Object Mask**: Premiere does not save its motion in the project, so it must be inside Opacity.
- The language, options, interval and Paste Straight are remembered the next time you open Premiere.
- Clips with changed speed (not 100%) are not supported as a target yet.
- With several clips, Ctrl+Z undoes one clip at a time.
- Click any message in the panel to copy its text.
- When a new version is out on GitHub, a notice shows at the top of the panel. To check right away, use **Check for updates** at the end of the Help tab.

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